

Jamie Burkart

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Re: Senior Product Manager — SPEED, Job ID 789610

Dear NYC Office of Technology and Innovation Hiring Team,

At KC Town Hall, a building idea could not remain an image of a possible future. It had to become a sequence that residents, vendors, City reviewers, and future occupants could understand and act on. Co-leading the adaptive reuse meant connecting participatory planning and public-benefit documentation to technical scope, vendor coordination, municipal compliance, and a public funding request. The visible building was held up by a less visible system of requirements, dependencies, decisions, and handoffs.

That is what draws me to the SPEED Senior Product Manager role. Permitting is not only a form or workflow; it is a relationship among people trying to build, public servants protecting shared standards, agencies holding different parts of the truth, and technical systems carrying decisions across time. A useful product roadmap has to diagnose the root constraint, distinguish policy from process and interface, establish a credible business case, and make tradeoffs plain enough to influence people whose authority does not sit in one room.

Across Thick Arts, CallNYC, WOW List, NYC Artist Coalition, and FairRentNYC, I have taken ambiguous public-facing work from discovery and systems analysis through information architecture, requirements, prioritization, implementation, launch, and learning. I have built the software, facilitated contested conversations, briefed elected officials and staff, supported users, and maintained shared decision records. I know the difference between participating in a collective outcome and claiming authority for it; that distinction makes product leadership more trustworthy, not less decisive.

The central lesson is simple: speed without legibility moves uncertainty downstream. I would want SPEED's products to shorten the resident and applicant journey by making requirements, status, ownership, and next actions clearer while preserving the reasons public safeguards exist.

I would welcome a structured exercise around one permitting bottleneck: map the actors and systems, test the root cause, define a version-one boundary and KPIs, identify the hardest dependency, and describe how the product team and agency partners would learn after launch. The durable possibility is a City process that becomes easier to navigate and an agency network better able to improve it together.

Warmly,

A handwritten signature in black ink, appearing to read 'Jamie Burkart', with a long, sweeping horizontal line extending to the right.

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